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October 21, 2026

MSAI Week 1 Reflection

Prior to this assignment, I had never realized how easy it was to change data just by opening it in another program like we did with Google Sheets. I had always thought the data would stay the same, and I would have to manually go in one by one to change it. After completing all parts of the assignment, I suddenly realized the programs automatically change the information. While working on part two, I created a CSV file containing five different customers and zip codes, and I made sure three of them started with 0. When I imported the file into google sheets, the zeros immediately disappeared. The zip codes went from 5 digit codes to 4. This surprised me because I didn't do anything besides upload the csv file I downloaded. Part three was similar but showed another way where data is interpreted and implemented differently. When I uploaded the bank statements into google sheets, the dates were flipped around. I think the dates were changed because google sheets operate under an American month/day/year format. If this were a real situation, we would need to make sure everything is in the same format because it could get very confusing if it was not. Finally, the Ziemann article explains that the Excel program was automatically converting gene names into numbers and dates. They found that almost 20% of papers published contained errors due to this flaw. This surprised me because computers and scientific researchers rely majorly on accurate data.

Overall, this assignment showed me the importance of accurate data and numbers when working with different sets of data. You have to be sure that the program you are uploading and using is also using the same format the data is set to.